YU-TING HUANG

PhD Candidate
Department of Economics
Georgia State University

Latest Update: September, 2026
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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, Georgia State University (2022–*Expected May 2027*)
Advisor: Lauren Hoehn-Velasco
Committee members: James Marton, Elaine Meichen Liu, Melanie Guldi (University of Central Florida)
M.A. Economics, The University of Texas at Austin (2020-2022)
B.A. Economics, National Central University, Taiwan (2016-2020)
Study Abroad Program, University of Groningen, Netherlands (2019-2020)
Summer Exchange, Linköping University, Sweden (2018)
Summer Exchange, Shanghai Jiao Tong University, China (2017)

RESEARCH INTEREST

Health Economics, Public Economics, Labor Economics, Economics of Education, Digital Economics

PUBLICATIONS

The Long Shadow of Typhoons: Prenatal Exposure and Adult Mental Health
(with Elaine Meichen Liu, Jin-Tan Liu, and Tzu-Yin Hazel Tseng)
*Accepted, *Journal of Development Economics*

Public Payment Mandates and Provider Supply: Evidence from Certified Nurse-Midwives
(with Lauren Hoehn-Velasco and Olanrewaju Yusuff)
*Accepted, *American Journal of Health Economics*

WORKING PAPERS

Bytes and Births: The Effect of Broadband Internet on Infant Health **JMP*

Full Day Kindergarten Mandates and Child Maltreatment (with Bogyung Kim)

WORKS IN PROGRESS

Universal Pre-Kindergarten, Childlessness, and Fertility (with Bogyung Kim)

EMPLOYMENT

Georgia State University
Research Assistant for Prof. Lauren Hoehn-Velasco (2023–Present)
Research Assistant for Prof. Michael Pesko regarding Tobacco Regulatory Science (2022-2023)

London Business School
Research Assistant for Prof. Bukky Akinsanmi Oyedeji (2022-2024)

The University of Texas at Austin

Research Assistant for Prof. Olivier Coibion and Prof. Nitya Pandalai-Nayar (2020-2022)

Institute for Information Industry, Taiwan

Assistant researcher, Robotics and Digital Healthcare, Market Intelligence & Consulting Institute (2020-2021)

TEACHING

Georgia State University

Instructor of Record, Global Economy, Undergraduate (2025 Spring)
Class size: 88 (In-person), Overall evaluation: 4.5/5

National Central University, Taiwan

Teaching Assistant, Microeconomics, Undergraduate (2019)
Teaching Assistant, NCU Learning By Doing Student Team Head (2017-2019)

CONFERENCES AND PRESENTATIONS (*Scheduled)

2027	American Economic Association Annual Meeting, Washington, D.C. (Presenter)*
2026	Southern Economic Association, Houston, TX (Organized Session/Presenter)*
	4th AEA CSQIEP Mentoring Conference, Chicago, IL (Presenter)
	Economics of Mental Health Workshop, Paris, France (Presenter)
	American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon), Minneapolis, MN (Presenter/Poster)
	Association for Education Finance & Policy (AEFP), Chicago, IL (Presenter)
	Public Policy and Child Well-being (PPCW), Atlanta, GA (Presenter)
	GSU Graduate Research Conference, Atlanta, GA (Presenter)
2025	Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (APPAM), Seattle, WA (Presenter)
	American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon), Nashville, TN (Presenter)

HONORS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND GRANTS

2026	Roe L. Johns Travel Grant Award, Association for Education Finance & Policy
2025-2026	Ramsey & Usery Chair Funds, Georgia State University
2024, 2025	E.D. (Jack) Dunn Fellowship, Georgia State University
2022-2026	Second Century Initiative Doctoral Fellowship, Georgia State University
2020	Merit-Based Scholarship, University of Texas at Austin
2019	Li-Sing Tsai Scholarship (exchange program), National Central University, Taiwan
2016-2019	Academic Presidential Award (~top 5%), National Central University, Taiwan

SKILLS

Coding Languages: Stata, R, Python, LaTeX, Markdown, SPSS
Languages: English (fluent), Chinese (native)

REFEREEING

The European Journal of Health Economics

REFERENCES

Prof. Lauren Hoehn-Velasco
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Prof. James Marton
Chair and Professor
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Prof. Elaine M. Liu
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PAPER ABSTRACT

Bytes and Births: The Effect of Broadband Internet on Infant Health

This paper examines whether changes in the information environment affect infant health outcomes. I exploit the staggered expansion of residential broadband across U.S. counties in the early 2000s and link broadband availability to individual birth records. I find that a hundred percent increase in broadband availability raises average birth weight by 7.5 grams. The estimated effects are comparable in magnitude to those of major U.S. safety-net programs. The gains are concentrated among disadvantaged populations, suggesting that the internet may have narrowed, rather than widened, disparities in early-life health. Moreover, broadband reduces the total fertility rate and alters the composition of births, yet infant health improves even as births shift toward higher-risk groups. Overall, the results provide evidence that the consequences of digital technologies extend beyond family formation to the next generation's health endowments.

The Long Shadow of Typhoons: Prenatal Exposure and Adult Mental Health

This paper examines how poor in utero conditions caused by severe typhoons affect psychological well-being later in life. We exploit variation in the timing and location of severe typhoon landfalls. Our design compares individuals with higher expected fetal exposure in landfall counties to those with no such exposure. A one-unit increase in expected in utero exposure raises the likelihood of an adult mental illness diagnosis by 2.2 percentage points, or 11 percent relative to the mean. The incidence of mood disorders such as depression and the use of antidepressants have risen by more than 50 percent. The adverse effects are concentrated among women. In a fully interacted model, we reject equality of the male and female effects for our main outcomes. This gender gap is not driven by differential healthcare-seeking behavior. We discuss several non-mutually exclusive mechanisms that could generate a genuinely female-concentrated effect, including sex-specific fetal programming and mortality selection.

Public Payment Mandates and Provider Supply: Evidence from Certified Nurse-Midwives

Public insurance reimbursement policies shape the structure and reach of healthcare markets. In this study, we examine the 1980 federal Medicaid mandate requiring states to reimburse Certified Nurse-Midwives (CNMs), one of the first federal reforms targeting non-physician providers. We find the mandate increased midwife-attended deliveries by 1.1 percentage points in states that adopted the mandate before 1988. This 1.1 percentage point increase reflects a 69% rise in midwife deliveries, adding almost 1,300 midwife births annually per state by 1988. At least 45 percent of this increase in midwife deliveries reflects a true expansion in midwife care rather than reporting changes. We also document a geographic expansion of midwife services into unserved areas and increased CNM employment. Our findings demonstrate that reimbursement mandates alter healthcare delivery by expanding provider supply and reshaping the workforce.

Full Day Kindergarten Mandates and Child Maltreatment

This study examines the effect of state-mandated full-day kindergarten (FDK) expansion on child maltreatment using National Data Archive on Child Abuse and Neglect (NCANDS) child-level data, State Inpatient Databases (SID) hospital discharge data, and National Vital Statistics System (NVSS) mortality records. Leveraging the staggered rollout of FDK adoption across states with advanced difference-in-differences methods, we find that FDK policies lead to an increase of 3.5 physical abuse reports per 1,000 children, approximately 36% relative to the baseline mean. The absence of an effect on the share of substantiated physical abuse and fatalities suggests that FDK primarily improves the detection of maltreatment rather than increasing its underlying incidence. Supporting this interpretation, educator-filed physical abuse reports rise by approximately 30%, reflecting enhanced detection capacity among teachers and school staff, and potentially replacing reports from other professions. Overall, this research provides new evidence on the broader benefits of early childhood education, particularly its role in strengthening child safety environments.